11-28 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Evening Mum Was Sick and I Cooked Tomato-and-Egg Noodles

① Tuesday night, 18:37, my mother came home from work with a thick grey scarf wound twice around her neck and her eyes a little too bright. She put her handbag on the small shoe cabinet, sat down heavily on the hallway bench, and said softly, "Ming, I have a bit of fever. I think I will lie down before dinner." She tried to smile. I saw, under the smile, a thin tiredness I had not seen on her before. Dad was still at the city hospital on a night shift until 22:00. My sister was at her weekly piano lesson. That left **me, the kitchen, and Mum** — whose forehead, when I reached up to touch it carefully, was clearly warmer than my palm.

② I asked her, "Mum, will a bowl of tomato-and-egg noodles help? It is soft and warm." She closed her eyes for a second and nodded. "Ming, that would be lovely. But if anything is hard — the knife, the stove — please wait for your dad." I said yes. I meant it. I promised myself quietly that I would follow **the three rules** Dad had taught me: **one hand on the knife, a small flame, and never leave the kitchen while the stove is on**.

③ I went to the small kitchen and stood still for a moment. On the shelf sat two red tomatoes, still warm from the evening sun. In the basket, three fresh eggs. In the clear plastic drawer, a half bag of thin wheat noodles. I washed my hands twice — once with cold water, once with warm — and set out the tools: **one small knife**, one wooden chopping board, one medium pot, one small pot, a ladle, three bowls, and the small red stool Dad had made for me when I was eight.

④ I boiled the water in the medium pot for the noodles first. I cut the tomatoes carefully: four gentle slices to break the skin, then small cubes about the size of my little-fingernail. The juice ran onto the board. It felt **warm, alive, like a small harvest**. I cracked the two eggs into a clean blue bowl and whisked them with a pair of chopsticks until they were smooth and bright yellow. On the spice shelf, I took a pinch of salt, half a teaspoon of sugar (to balance the sour of the tomato), a few drops of soy sauce, and a tiny amount of light vegetable oil.

⑤ Then I turned on the small pot with a **small flame** — exactly as Dad had taught. I waited until the oil shimmered slightly, then slid the eggs in. The kitchen filled with a warm, comforting smell, the kind that had welcomed me home every winter since I was small. I stirred until the eggs were just softly cooked, then scooped them into a clean dish. Into the same pot, I added the tomato cubes and stirred them with a wooden spoon

until they turned into a soft red sauce, bubbling quietly. Salt, sugar, soy sauce. I tasted a single drop on a small plastic spoon. It was nearly right. I added half a cup of water, brought the noodles in from the medium pot, and then, carefully, returned the eggs.

⑥ While stirring, I remembered how Mum always added **one small gift** at the end of her noodles for me — a tiny spoon of **sesame oil**, poured into the bowl after the flame was off. She said it made the whole bowl smell like "home, the way you remember it from childhood." I turned off both stoves. I set the bowl on a wooden tray. I poured one small spoon of sesame oil onto the top, and the kitchen released that deep, quiet fragrance. I took a small piece of spring onion — washed, dried, finely cut — and sprinkled it on the red surface like snow.

⑦ I carried the tray to Mum. She was lying on the sofa under a soft blue blanket, looking at the low ceiling. She sat up slowly when she heard me. She did not say "Wow" or "Well done"; she simply looked at the bowl for two seconds, looked at me for another two, and said very softly, **"Thank you, Ming. It smells exactly like home."** I helped her hold the bowl while she took the first spoon. She said, "A bit more salt next time. But this is good." I nodded seriously, noting the advice. I felt warm all the way from my ears to my toes.

⑧ Dad came home at 22:15. He saw the washed chopping board, the wiped stove, the small red stool under the window, and the blue bowl already empty beside Mum on the sofa. He did not say anything for a moment. He pulled me quietly into a hug, forehead against my hair, and said, "Ming, I am proud of you — not because you cooked, but because, after you cooked, **you remembered to wipe the stove**." I laughed. He laughed. Mum, half asleep, smiled from the sofa.

⑨ That night, I wrote three small lines in my diary. *"Mum is sick but safe. I made a bowl of noodles. Dad is proud because I wiped the stove."* I turned off my lamp and lay in the dark, listening to the soft sound of our building's heating pipe. I thought about how, tonight, I had moved — for the first time — from being the **person who is taken care of** to being the **person who takes care**, even for one small evening. The difference is not age, I realised; it is **attention**. Attention to a warm forehead. Attention to a small flame. Attention to the last part of the job — the wipe of the stove — that no one is watching. I fell asleep thinking: **this is how growing up actually sounds — not loud, but careful**.

注释： fever 发烧；ladle 长柄勺；shimmer 微微闪光；fragrance 香气；spring onion 小葱

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why did the writer decide to cook the noodles alone that evening?

A. Because her mother asked her to cook every night.
B. Because her mother came home with a fever and said she needed to lie down; Dad

was on a night shift at the hospital until 22:00 and her sister was at her weekly piano lesson, so only the writer and the kitchen were left with Mum.
C. Because she wanted to skip homework.
D. Because she was hungry and no one else would eat.

2. Which three kitchen rules had Dad taught the writer and she quietly promised to follow?

A. Cook fast, use a big knife, and turn the stove high.
B. One hand on the knife, a small flame, and never leave the kitchen while the stove is on.
C. Always cook with no light, salt every dish, and use cold water.
D. Use many pots, listen to music, and stir quickly.

3. What "small gift" did Mum usually add at the end of her noodles for the writer?

A. A spoon of honey.
B. A tiny spoon of sesame oil, poured in after the flame was off, which made the whole bowl smell like "home, the way you remember it from childhood."
C. A piece of chicken.
D. A slice of lemon.

4. Why did Dad hug the writer and say he was proud, and for what exact reason?

A. Because she had cooked a big dinner.
B. Because after she cooked, she remembered to wipe the stove — he said he was proud of her not for the cooking itself, but for finishing the last part of the job that no one was watching.
C. Because she had earned money.
D. Because she had passed an exam.

5. What is the writer's main realisation at the end of the passage?

A. That cooking is boring.
B. That growing up sounds loud and fast.
C. That tonight she had moved, for the first time, from being the person taken care of to being the person who takes care — the difference is not age, but attention: attention to a warm forehead, a small flame, and the wipe of the stove no one is watching.
D. That adults cook better.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题

【定位】第①段家庭安排
【解析】发烧妈妈 + 父亲夜班 + 姐姐钢琴课直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段爸爸的三条规则
【解析】直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段妈妈"小礼物"
【解析】香油直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑧段爸爸的话
【解析】"擦灶台"主旨直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑨段结尾
【解析】"差别不是年龄而是注意力"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。